Why Not Just Use Context API?

After learning about prop drilling, a common question is:

"React already has Context API. Why do we need Redux?"

That's a great question.

The answer is **not because Context API is bad**.

Context API is actually an excellent solution for many applications.

- Theme (Dark / Light)
- Logged-in User
- Language
- Authentication

Now Imagine a Large E-commerce Website

- User
- Cart
- Wishlist
- Orders
- Notifications
- Products
- Search
- Filters
- Theme

If all of this is managed inside Context, your state management can become difficult to organize as the application grows.

Problem 1 - Everything Lives Together

Imagine one Context managing everything.

```
AppContext
├── user
├── cart
├── wishlist
├── orders
├── theme
├── notifications
├── products
└── filters
```

After a few months, this file becomes very large. Finding where a piece of state is updated becomes harder.

Problem 2 - Business Logic Gets Mixed

- Adding a product
- Removing a product

- Login
- Logout
- Theme switching
- Notifications
- Wishlist
- Orders

Everything is mixed together. Maintaining that code becomes more difficult as features increase.

Problem 3 - Difficult to Scale

Suppose five developers are working on the same project.

- Developer 1 → Cart
- Developer 2 → User
- Developer 3 → Orders
- Developer 4 → Wishlist
- Developer 5 → Notifications

If everyone edits the same Context file, teamwork becomes harder.

Redux solves this by separating each feature into its own slice.

```
features
■■■ cart
■■■ user
■■■ orders
■■■ wishlist
■■■ notifications
```

Each developer can work independently.

Problem 4 - No Feature Separation

```
Cart Slice

Only Cart Logic
User Slice

Only User Logic
Theme Slice

Only Theme Logic
```

Every feature has its own place. The project stays clean and organized.

Problem 5 - Better Debugging

- Which action happened
- When it happened
- What data changed
- Previous state
- Current state

Redux DevTools makes debugging much easier in larger applications.

So Should We Stop Using Context API?

No.

Use Context API when your application has simple shared state, such as:

- Theme
- Language
- Logged-in User

Use Redux Toolkit when your application has many shared features, complex state updates, and multiple developers working on the project.

Redux Toolkit provides a more structured and scalable way to organize application state.